

THE MOTOWN UNIVERSE

Executive Development Memo #018 — Phase 2, Film 3: Release Date & Full Film Sheet

CONFIDENTIAL • An alternate-reality “what if” • Fidelity Rating: 100% • Nerf Tolerance: 0%

THE TEARS OF A CLOWN

LEAD: Smokey Robinson • RELEASE: Friday, April 3, 2015

Phase 2, Film 3 • The Captain America: The Winter Soldier role • Motown Productions / Paramount • PG-13 • approx. 155 min

A. Release Date: Friday, April 3, 2015

Captain America: The Winter Soldier opened on Friday, April 4, 2014. Exactly 52 weeks later is **Friday, April 3, 2015**, the TMU's first spring release.

B. The Winter Soldier Blueprint Map

Captain America: The Winter Soldier	The Tears of a Clown (documented history)
The loyal soldier in a changing world	Smokey, Motown's loyal vice president, as the Detroit family changes around him
S.H.I.E.L.D. collapsing from within	The Detroit family comes apart: HDH walk out, the city burns, and Motown leaves for Los Angeles (1972)
The Winter Soldier: something buried comes back	“The Tears of a Clown”: recorded in 1967, buried on an album, then released in 1970, when it hits #1 in the UK and the US
Bucky, the best friend, ends up on another path	Ronnie White keeps the Miracles going when Smokey leaves the group (1972)
Falcon, the new partner	Guitarist Marv Tarplin, co-writer of “The Tracks of My Tears”

C. Full Film Sheet (Memo #008)

1. Title: *The Tears of a Clown*

It's the exact title of the 1970 #1 hit. A smiling performer hiding the pain fits a leader holding everyone together while his own world shifts. To the public, it's a song title (Memo #007).

2. What's Being Adapted

Source	Used for
Primary: Smokey Robinson with David Ritz, <i>Smokey: Inside My Life</i> (1989)	Smokey's point of view, Claudette, and leaving the Miracles
Berry Gordy, <i>To Be Loved</i> (1994)	Smokey's role as vice president and the move to Los Angeles
The master recordings, label credits, and the Billboard and UK chart records	Every song, credit and chart position on screen

3. What the Movie Is About

Logline: Motown's most loyal soldier writes the soundtrack of a generation while the family he helped build falls apart around him, until a song he'd buried comes back and tells him it's time to come home.

Act One: The Poet at His Peak (1964–1966). Smokey writes “My Girl” and “The Way You Do the Things You Do” for the Temptations. The Miracles record “Ooo Baby Baby” and “The Tracks of My Tears” (1965). On the road, Claudette suffers miscarriages and leaves touring.

Act Two: The Family Cracks (1966–1969). At the 1966 Motown Christmas party, Stevie Wonder and Hank Cosby hand Smokey a circus-sounding instrumental. He writes “The Tears of a Clown,” and it's buried on a 1967 album. HDH leave, and Detroit burns. As vice president, Smokey stays loyal. He names his children Berry and Tamla, and he wants to be home with them.

Act Three: The Buried Song Returns (1970–1972). Released as a single in 1970, “The Tears of a Clown” goes to #1 in the UK and then the US. At his peak, Smokey leaves the Miracles for his family and for Motown. After his farewell shows (1972), Ronnie White carries on the group, and Smokey moves west with the company.

4. Whose Movie / Franchise It Is

Smokey Robinson's. This is his second solo film, with the loyal heart of the TMU at full strength (No-Nerf).

5. Antagonist

Level	Antagonist	What the record supports
Primary	The Detroit family falling apart from within	HDH leaving, the riot, and finally the move out of Detroit. The institution Smokey served changes under him, like S.H.I.E.L.D. collapsing.
Personal	The cost of the road	Claudette's miscarriages and missing his family. This is documented in his memoir.

6. Timeline: When & Where

	Setting
When	1964 to 1972. The fixed points are “The Tracks of My Tears” (1965), the 1966 Christmas party, “The Tears of a Clown” at #1 in the UK and US (1970), and Smokey leaving the Miracles (1972).
Where	Detroit (Hitsville and Studio A), the touring circuit, and Los Angeles (1972).
Master timeline	TMU Chapter Eight. It picks up after <i>Smokey and the Revue</i> (1962), overlapping <i>Hitsville 2</i> and <i>Hitsville 3</i> .

7. Standalone World-Building

Smokey as songwriter, husband, father and executive. How the songs were written, the Miracles' inner circle, and home life with Claudette. The story is complete from peak to farewell.

8. Motown Universe World-Building

Type	Established in <i>The Tears of a Clown</i>
Crossovers	The “My Girl” session, shared with <i>(I Know) I'm Losing You</i> and <i>Hitsville 2</i> . The 1972 move to Los Angeles, shared with <i>Hitsville 3</i> .
Returning	Gordy, the Miracles, Claudette, the Temptations and Little Stevie Wonder, played by the same actors.
Seeds	Stevie Wonder, now a songwriter (setting up <i>Signed, Sealed, Delivered I'm Yours</i>), and Gladys Knight & the Pips (see mid-credits).

9. Post-Credits Scenes: Two

Scene	What happens
Mid-credits (Studio A, 1967)	Gladys Knight & the Pips cut “I Heard It Through the Grapevine” with Norman Whitfield. It's the same song Marvin will later record. This introduces the new faces of the second team-up, just as <i>The Winter Soldier</i> 's mid-credits introduced the Maximoff twins.
End-credits (1975)	The Miracles, now without Smokey, record “Love Machine” (a #1 in 1976). Between takes, Ronnie White looks at an old photo of the kids from the North End. It mirrors Bucky visiting his own exhibit at the Smithsonian.

10. How It Kicks Everything Off

N/A. This field is for the first film only (Memo #008).

Compliance Check

Mandate	Status
Fidelity (Memo #001)	PASS. Every event, song, credit and date comes from the documented record.
No-Nerf (Memo #001)	PASS. Every character appears at full documented strength.
Studio (Memos #002–#003)	PASS. Motown Productions, distributed by Paramount.
Phase (Memo #004)	PASS. Phase 2, Film 3 of 6. Released April 3, 2015.
Story model (Memo #005)	PASS. 60% serialized / 40% standalone (Phase 2 target).
Format (Memo #005)	PASS. Musical Biographical Drama, PG-13, approx. 155 min.
Continuity (Memo #005)	PASS. The same actors return, and the “My Girl” session and the Los Angeles move match their shared films.
Secrecy (Memo #007)	PASS. Publicly marketed as a Smokey Robinson biopic sequel, with no universe branding.

TMU is a fan-made alternate-reality concept. It has no connection to Motown Records, Universal, Paramount or Marvel Studios. The people named are real. The films and the roles here are fictional.